

2.1 Unit description

Introduction

Coherence is achieved in the Advanced Subsidiary course by the links between the themes in Unit 1 and the depth studies in this unit. Each of the studies in this unit explores issues of power, influence and control in society within the context of British history. These issues, including politics, values and beliefs, are conceptually linked and are extended through the themes specified in Unit 1. These themes, in conjunction with their British history studies, will allow students to reflect upon the operation of power and the forces for change in power relationships in different societies or (in the case of those following an exclusively British history route) at different times.

In this unit, students will study British history in some depth. Grounded in an exploration of source material in its historical context, this unit enables students to develop an in-depth understanding of the attitudes, beliefs and structures of the societies they study.

In working with selected sources, students will be required to demonstrate evidence skills which enable them to make reasoned and supported judgements and to address a historical view or claim.

Option papers available for Unit 2

Students must follow one of options A-E. Each option includes two topics. Students are required to study ONE topic from one option paper.

Option A: Early Modern British History: Crown and Authority

Option B: British Political History in the 19th Century

Option C: Conflict and Change in 19th and 20th Century Britain

Option D: The British Empire Challenged

Option E: Britain in the Later 20th Century: Responding to Change